

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

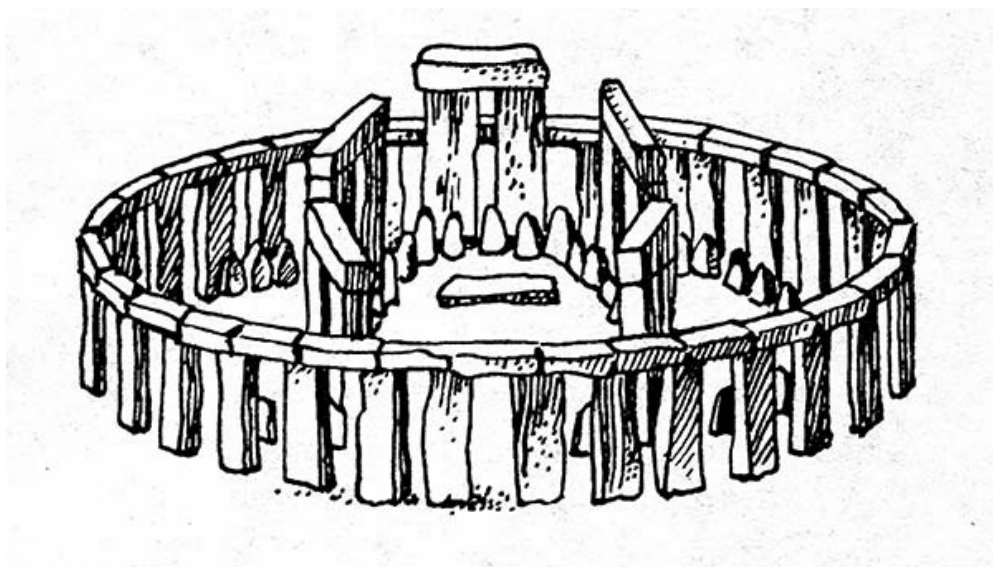
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Let's Start!

It's a Neolithic village!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about history and civilization.
- I can report facts about events or actions.
- I can talk about unusual events in the past.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about life in Neolithic times about 5000 years ago?
- What type of homes do you think people built at that time?





Let's Explore!

The houses are set into mounds of **midden***.

* "Midden" is a pile of garbage or waste like animal bones or seeds.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

After a wild storm in the winter of 1850, the Neolithic village of Skara Brae was discovered. The great storm ripped the grass off a mound and exposed an immense refuse heap. It also brought to light ruins. They were ancient buildings made of stone. These dwellings have proven to be the most highly preserved Neolithic village, not only in Britain, but also in all of western Europe.

Astonishingly, Skara Brae was inhabited 5000 years ago. People lived and traded there for centuries before Stonehenge began to rise. Not even the pyramids were built yet. However, it is not the age of the town that has made it noteworthy. It is how this age-old town has been preserved. The semi-subterranean buildings in the village have survived in a state that archaeologists have found impressive. So, amazingly, have the furniture pieces inside the homes. This is a unique window into the past that has allowed us to see how people once lived. Skara Brae's importance was recognized in 1999 when it was added to the World Heritage list as a Neolithic site.

What you notice when you go into Skara Brae, is that the houses have been built well with smooth stone slabs. These have been built into midden mounds that have been linked together by covered passageways. Each house was made up of a single room, about 450 square feet.

All of the homes were alike. Stone furniture was fitted into each room - in each, a stone dresser, two box-beds and a hearth or fireplace. A large structure on one side of the village has been identified as a workshop.

Because such an abundant variety of artefacts, animal bones, tools and pottery have been uncovered as it has been excavated, archaeologists assume that the village was abandoned quickly, surprisingly suggesting that they did not need to defend themselves and therefore had peaceful lives.





Let's Practice!

Ray talks about Neolithic Skara Brae village.

Instructions: Read the article on page 2 again. Select the correct option.

1. Skara Brae ...

- a. is a refuse heap.
- b. was discovered in 1850.
- c. was discovered in summer.
- d. brought a prehistoric village.
- e. is in southern Europe.

2. Skara Brae ...

- a. is 3,000 years old.
- b. is still inhabited.
- c. was built after Stonehenge.
- d. is older than the Egyptian pyramids.
- e. is larger than the Egyptian pyramids.



Let's Practice!

Nick looks for more information about Skara Brae. Here's what he found!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write whether the sentence is in Simple Past Passive or Present Perfect Passive in front of each sentence.

1. _____ A rich array of artefacts and natural remains has been discovered during the various archaeological excavations.
2. _____ It is the degree to which it has been preserved that is important.
3. _____ Archaeologists assume that the village was abandoned quickly.
4. _____ It was placed on the World Heritage list as a Neolithic site.
5. _____ The houses have been built well with closely-fitting flat stone slabs.
6. _____ The site was given official recognition in 1999.
7. _____ Astonishingly, Skara Brae was inhabited before the Egyptian pyramids were built.
8. _____ Surprisingly, no weapons have been found suggesting a peaceful life.
9. _____ The Neolithic village of Skara Brae was discovered in the winter of 1850.



Extension Activity

Find out about a Neolithic village.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read through the text again.
- Go online or to the library to find out about a Neolithic village.
- Make notes about where the place is, who found it, who lived there and what it looked like.
- Prepare a short presentation on the village site. Use the Present Perfect tense and the Simple Past tense in both Active and Passive voice.
- Share your presentation with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I read about a Neolithic village.

☐ ☐

I write a text answering wh- questions and prepare a short presentation on the village site.

☐ ☐

I use the Present Perfect tense and the Simple Past tense in both Active and Passive voice.

☐ ☐

I give my presentation to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to rip** (verb): to remove with violence and speed
e.g. The wild storm ripped the grass from Skara Brae revealing underneath a large pile of refuse.
- Neolithic** (adjective): refers to the last part of the Stone Age characterized by domestication of animals, development of agriculture and polished stone instruments
e.g. The Neolithic village of Skara Brae was discovered in the winter of 1850.
- to expose** (verb): to make visible
e.g. When a wild storm ripped the grass from Skara Brae, it exposed an immense refuse heap.
- refuse heap** (noun): an accumulation of discarded waste materials
e.g. Under the grass at Skara Brae was an immense refuse heap.
- to bring to light** (expression): to expose, to make visible
e.g. It also brought to light the ruins of ancient stone buildings.
- semi-subterranean** (adjective): partially underground
e.g. The structures of this semi-subterranean village have survived in impressive condition.
- slab** (noun): a thick piece
e.g. The houses have been built well with closely-fitting flat stone slabs.
- artefact** (noun): an object that is of historical and cultural value
e.g. Because such a rich array of artefacts and natural remains has been discovered during the various archaeological excavations, archaeologists assume that the village was abandoned quickly.
- to abandon** (verb): to leave or desert
e.g. Because such a rich array of artefacts and natural remains has been discovered during the various archaeological excavations, archaeologists assume that the village was abandoned quickly.



Learning Points

Simple Past Active and Passive Forms

You use the **Simple Past** tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

This tense can have active and passive forms.

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing.

Look at the chart for the examples of the form of both the active and passive voices of the **Simple Past**:

	Simple Past
Active	People discovered the village of Skara Brae in the winter of 1850.
Passive	The Neolithic village of Skara Brae was discovered in the winter of 1850.

Examples:

- Astonishingly, Skara Brae **was inhabited** before the Egyptian pyramids **were built**.
- Archaeologists assume that the village **was abandoned** quickly.
- The site **was given** official recognition in 1999.
- It **was placed** on the World Heritage list as a Neolithic site.





Learning Points

Present Perfect Active and Passive Forms

You use the **Present Perfect** to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

This tense can also have active and passive forms.

Look at the chart for the examples of the form of both the active and passive voices of the **Present Perfect**:

Active	<i>They have built the houses well, with closely-fitting flat stone slabs.</i>
Passive	<i>The houses have been built well with closely-fitting flat stone slabs.</i>

Examples:

- *It is the degree to which it **has been preserved** that is important.*
- *They **have been set** into large mounds of midden.*
- *They **have been linked** together by covered passageways.*
- *A rich array of artefacts and natural remains **has been discovered** during the various archaeological excavations.*

